INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

ENTREPRENEURSHIP TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
2. Select target market.
3. Conduct SWOT analysis for use in the marketing planning process.
4. Explain the concept of competition.
5. Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of small business consultants. The owner (judge) of MOBILE PAWS, a mobile pet grooming business, wants your team's advice on expanding to a new market.

The owner (judge) started MOBILE PAWS two years ago with one van that drives to customers' homes to bathe, trim and groom dogs and cats. Business has been strong:

- The van is booked six days a week, and new customers wait about three weeks for an appointment.
- 85% of customers live in one neighborhood of single-family homes.
- A typical grooming costs $85, compared with $60 at the two grooming salons in town.
- Most new customers heard about MOBILE PAWS from a neighbor or a neighborhood social media group.

The owner (judge) plans to buy a second van and is deciding which new market to serve. One option is a nearby suburb with many retirees who have trouble driving their pets to a salon. The other option is downtown, where new apartment buildings are full of busy young professionals with small dogs. The owner (judge) recently heard that a national pet store chain is testing its own mobile grooming service in the region.

The owner (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain MOBILE PAWS' current market and the two possible new markets.
- Recommend which target market the second van should serve and why.
- Conduct a SWOT analysis of MOBILE PAWS.
- Explain how competition from salons and the national chain could affect the business.
- Recommend word-of-mouth channels to reach the new target market.

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a meeting at a local coffee shop. The owner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Word of mouth worked in my first neighborhood. How do I get it started somewhere I don't know anyone?
2. How will we know after six months whether the second van was a good decision?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of market and market identification.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Select target market.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Conduct SWOT analysis for use in the marketing planning process.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the concept of competition.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	